NOTES ON A MAYO DIALECT

THE notes and jottings printed below are based on a tape recording of an evening's conversation I had (date 21 May 1968) with James Deasy (henceforth referred to as JD), who lives on a small holding at Rinn an Eanaigh a few miles below Foxford, Co. Mayo. JD is in his seventies, and as a young man during the 1914–18 war laboured on farms in England. It seems he is the only fluent Irish speaker left in Rinn an Eanaigh. The reason for his being so fluent, in contrast to his neighbours, is that he was reared away from home with relatives who spoke only Irish. He has very limited opportunities nowadays to practise his Irish.

Not many miles from Rinn an Eanaigh lies An Chuing Mhór beside the small bridge on the Foxford side of Pontoon. When I came to know An Chuing first, in 1929, the old and middle-aged inhabitants there spoke a rich and pure Irish. It is my regret that I did not make a study of this speech and prepare a description of it. Neither Rinn an Eanaigh nor An Chuing appears on the Linguistic Atlas.

Phonology, Accidence etc.

The symbols here used are those of *The Irish of Erris, Co. Mayo* (henceforth IE), with the two additions æ and h′. The phonemic structure of JD's Irish seems to be almost the same as that of IE. His /d′/ and /t′/ are affricates (= dʒ, tʃ) except following /ʃ/ where they are plosives. JD has in general a less open front *a*-sound than that heard in Erris. In the word *breaghdha* he uses a long front vowel nearer to half-open than to open position, that is to say nearer to ɛː than to aː. Medially and finally in words JD's /ç/ has much less audible friction than in Erris Irish. In such positions I have adopted the symbol h′, to represent this voiceless counterpart of j.

Nasalization

Nasalization is not so prominent in JD's Irish as it is in Erris, yet it occurs clearly in the word *reamhar*, e.g. n′iː wan′hə m′eː ro rãwər iː 'I won't cut it too thick', and in *mónadh* mõːnuː.

Sandhi

Sandhi is well represented in JD's speech. Examples are v′iː kosiː ən æḍ ʃin′ er′ 'he had legs that length'; sdad nə ŋraːsd *staid na ngrásta*; ə lərṭ l′eʃ nə bah 'speaking to the cows'; t′ig′ l′at ə raːṭ l′oːf 'you can

tell them'; du:rṭ ʃe: l'iN' 'he told us'; ə to:rṭ suəs 'giving up'; ə xiN'a:l'ṭ bog 'to keep it soft'; mər du:rṭ m'e: hanə he:n' l'at 'as I told you already'; du:rṭ mid' l'e:nə ma:ti: 'we said to our mates'; La: ə ban'ṭ mo:nu: '(one) day cutting turf'; v'i: ʃe: to:rṭ puNtə ɣum 'he was giving me a pound'; ə fa:l'ṭ kuplə ʃg'il'iN' 'getting a couple of shillings'; ə ho:ga:l'ṭ wem' 'to take it from me'; hit Nə La:wə ʃi:s 'the hands fell down'.

Historical sandhi before an *s*-pronoun in the cond. and impf. is well exemplified, e.g. k'e: b'i: ga:v ə v'eṭ ʃe: aN 'whatever tight corner he would be in' (see IE § 575).

Note sandhi does not appear in the following exx: kid' gə Nə boxəL'i: 'some of the boys'; kid' ɣe 'some of it'.

r' > r in the following: as k'uN kla:r sə L'abi: 'laid out on the bed'; Na:du:r Nə Ni:n'i: 'the nature of the people'; fuər ʃe:n wo:n' sə t'i:r ʃo 'he got the turf in this country'. In this last example r ʃ are homorganic post-alveolar, somewhat inverted (IE § 140).

Stress

Chief stress is generally on the first syllable of the word. This is also true of words having the prefix *sean-*, e.g. eg' Nə 'ʃaNdi:n'i: *ag na seandaoinibh*. The word *sleaghán* 'turf-spade' is disyllabic with JD. He sometimes pronounces it with chief stress on the first syllable, e.g. Nuər'ə xa m'e: fo:d mo:nu: gəN' 't'iL'a:n 'when I threw a sod of turf off the *sleaghán*', and sometimes with even stress, e.g. gəN' 't'i'L'a:n. (Cf. IE § 332). Chief stress is on the second syllable of the following: Nə po:'li:s 'the police'; *tiomáint*, e.g. ʃaxd gart' ə t'ə'ma:nt' weN' (= dhuinn) 'seven carts drawing (corn) to us'; əgəs hə'ma:n' ʃe: l'eʃ 'and he drove ahead'.

Stress is on the second syllable of pronominal compounds of the preposition *ag* where the rhythm pattern requires it, e.g. ənsə ga:r ə v'ert' ə'giN' 'in the car, the two of us'; gə N'artə d'iə n' v'ert' ə'gi: 'God strengthen the two of ye' (see IE § 265).

Examples showing stress in the phrases *fadó, fadó shoin*: v'i: f'ar 'fado: 'there was a man long ago'; v'i: g'aL 'fado: hin' ad'ir' do:nəL o: kunəL' əgəs sasəNəx 'there was a bet long ago between Dan O'Connell and an Englishman'.

Where two epithets are used the second is the more strongly stressed, e.g. bal'ə mo:r 'br'æ: *baile mór breaghdha*.

An instance of the personal pronoun *mé* very strongly stressed occurs in wih'ə 'm'e: *mhothuigh mé!* 'I did hear!', in an emphatic, almost enthusiastic answer to a question.

Endings

-(a)idh, -(a)igh = i:

Examples: kahi: f'ir' fo:ləmhi: im'əxd as ə dəun' ʃo ' even learned men must die '; Nax gahi: din'ə k'i:nt' ə v'eh ən'ʃin' ' mustn't some one have been there? '; N'i:r wihi: (before pause) ' I didn't (ever) hear '; gə N'əir'i: də wo:hər l'at ' good luck to you '; t'anəm l'um, t'ig'i: l'iN' ' come on, come with us! '.

-idh is reduced to ə before a pronoun subject, e.g. kah'ə m'e: ɣol ə glanu: kuplə baŋk mo:nu: ə'ma:rəx l'e: ku:nu: d'e: ' I must go to clean a couple of banks of turf tomorrow, please God '; kah'ə tu: v'eh əN də xi:nt'o:r' waih' l'e: v'eh əN də ço:Lto:r' waih' ' you must be a good *keener* to be a good singer '; kah'ə ʃi: Nə hiv'əxə b'ogə max ' she will throw out the small eggs '; kasə ʃi: ' she will turn '; d'im'ə m'e: ən'ʃin' ' I went away then '.

-aigh is reduced to ə in the place name *Corcaigh*, e.g. ə Nuəs ə gorkə.

-uidh in *suidh* and *-igh* in *bligh* > i when followed by a pronoun subject, e.g. hi m'e: ʃi:s er' ə sdo:l ' I sat down on the stool '; vl'i ʃi: i: ' she milked her '.

-(e)adh

-(e)adh is generally pronounced u:, e.g. du:rt Nə sasəNi: gə mrih'u: ən guəl e: N'i:s tapəxi: ' the Englishmen said that the coal would boil it sooner '; ogəs hret'u: (before pause) ' and they *would* fight (too)! '; N'i: ɣohu: din'ə mu: ə mal' a: 'kl'iə ' one would not be lost in Dublin '.

In one case at least *-eadh* was clearly pronounced əv: hik'əv Nə ba ən ɣe:l'ik' ' the cows understood (used understand) the Irish '.

In certain set phrases where it is flanked by a consonant *-adh* is frequently reduced to ə, e.g. hukə l'o:f ge:l'ik' ə ləurt' ' they could speak Irish '; Na: d'ukə l'o:f a:lt' ə'max, waro:ḍ ʃi·d e: ' if they could find him out, they would kill him '; N'i: hukə l'um ə rih'ə ʃi:s ' I couldn't run him down '.

Where an *s*-pronoun subject follows, *-adh* > əḍ, e.g. gə mr'iʃəḍ ʃi: də xosi: ' that she would break your legs '.

In certain set phrases *-adh* in nouns also is reduced to ə, e.g. wel' mulə gə jiə, v'i: trə hno:nə br'æ: ə'giN' ' well, thanks be to God, we have had a fine evening '.

In the word *dligheadh -eadh* > v, e.g. dl'i:v sasəNi: ə v'i: sə t'i:r ʃo ' it was English law that was in this country '.

-lbh, -rbh

There seemed to be fluctuation between əv and uw in such words as *garbh, balbh*, e.g. N'i:l' ʃi: garəv/garuw ' she (the cuckoo) is not rough-voiced '. (Cf. O'Rahilly, *Irish Dialects*, p. 55, n. 2.)

It should be remarked that JD's final w in *snámh, a-riamh*, and such words, is more than a mere semi-vowel. It is sometimes strongly fricative, suggesting velarized v.

ó-fut. and -cond.

Examples: inʃo: m'e: t'iL'u: ɣit' ' I'll tell you more '; NUər' ə heʃo:j ʃi: ə g'e:r'i: balәv/baluw ' when she starts getting hoarse '; N'i: çaNo:N' ba r b'ih' ə sasəNi: ' I wouldn't buy any cows in England '.

There are two examples of the cond. *-óghadh* not followed by a pronoun subject, viz. ə waro:uv Nə k'e:ti: ' who would kill hundreds '; f'iə sNa:w iʃg'ə ə d'im'o:xu: ' a deer swimming water that would get away '.

When followed by an *s*-pronoun subject the form used in the cond. is -o:ḍ, e.g. d'im'o:ḍ ʃe: ' he would go '.

Elision

Vowels

Many examples of waning vowel in terminal position occur, thus: l'o:f *leóbhtha*, wuf *uatha*, tus *tusa*, erʃə m'iʃ *arsa mise*, boki: ə bot *bogtha i bpota*, Nax b'in' i: ə N'i:r'iN' *nach b'in i an fhirinne?* (Cf. IE § 242).

Consonants

Examples: xor ə b'ih' (*ar*) *chor ar bith*; l'e: gu maih' ə v'e ogəd *le guth maith a bheith agat*; ənə sga ki:nt'o:r'i: *i n-a sgaith caointeóiri*.

Interchange of Vowels

a for *i*, e.g. N'i: b'an falsə v'i: ant'i: *ní bean fallsa a bhí innte*.

u for *ua*, e.g. bə del'i: ə wulu: *budh doiligh a bhualadh* ' it would be hard to beat him '.

i: is substituted for final *-a, -e* in past participles and in some adjectives, e.g. b'a:r l'um ə ka:r ə v'e br'iʃd'i: ' I'd prefer the car to be broken '; rint'i: ' divided '; brit'i: ' boiled '; ta:s eg' Nə f'ir' fo:ləmhi: e: ' the learned men know it '; ta: tu: gofi: er d'er'u: hiər ' you are caught at last '; v'i: mə fi:pə L'aki: er' ə maŋk ' my pipe was laid on the bank '; f'ar br'æ: L'ik'i: sgi:lt'i: ' a fine loose lithe man '; ta: kal'i:n' ek'i: po:sdi: ə sasəNi: ' she has a daughter married in England '; gə k'int'i: ' surely '. *eile* does not develop i:, e.g. ə Na:t' el'ə ' in another place '.

-ighthe is sometimes pronounced i:, but there are instances where it is pronounced içə or ih'ə, which may be reduced to iç in a terminal position. Examples are ta: Nə f'iəklə im'ih'ə ' the teeth are gone '; tobər b'aNiç or b'aNəç ' a holy well '.

Interchange of Consonants

Examples: *beach* > *meach*; fuə n wo: hart *chuaidh an bhó thart.* But in one place xuə seems to have been used. There is a tendency to substitute d' for L', e.g. himp'əl d'ah uər' ə xlig' riv'ə *timcheall leath-uair a' chluig roimhe.* p' > p, e.g. pi:pi: ' pipes '. The simple preposition *ar* has become *oir* er', e.g. er' xu: *ar chú. go* replaces *chomh*, e.g. b'e:d'ər gə wiL tu: gə suni: ' perhaps you are just as well off (not married) '. t > t', e.g. v'i: t'iʃg'int' k'iN' aN ' he was highly intelligent '; ə d'ig'əN tu: ge:l'ik' *an dtuigeann tú Gaoidhilg?*; t'iL'u: *tuilleadh.*

Cases of excrescent t' after final consonant are quite common, e.g. l'e: də xiN'a:lt' er' ja: sdad' ' to keep you in a good state '; ə fa:lt' gr'im' er' ' getting a grip of him '; v'i: d'ef'ir' orəm l'e:n a:lt' bant'i: ' I was in a hurry to get it cut '; b'e:g'əN du:N' a:ga:lt' ' we had to leave it '; La:w ə L'agənt' orəm ' to lay a hand on me '.

Eclipsis

Following preposition plus sg. article eclipsis is the rule in JD's speech, e.g. po:sti: ənsə mal'ə mo:r *pósta insan mbaile mór*; sə gapəL *san gcapall*; l'eʃ ə min' *leis an mboin*; er' ə gasu: *ar an gcasadh*; as ə grak'əN *as an gcraiceann.* Examples of eclipsis following gən *den/don* are: gən gant' *den gcainnt*; gən grak'əN *den gcraiceann.* There is one example involving initial *s*, in which the mutation is ʃ > t', thus l'eʃ ə tr'i:n *leis an tsrian.* At least one case of lenition instead of eclipsis occurs: riv' ə ɣuəl *roimh an ghual.*

Numerals

Examples: himp'əls k'er'ə fo:d Na: ku:g' ' about four sods or five '; himp'əls haxd ml'iən' o: 'hin' ' about seven years ago '; han'ik' ʃe: n' tr'i:fə ṭorṇ ' he came the third time '; k'ahər ə'giN' ' four of us '; v'i: tr'i: Na: k'ahər gə fa:ʃd'i: ek'i: ' she had three or four children '; gə mo:r l'e: 'mo:rheʃər ə'ku: ' as big as seven of them '; mo:rheʃər mra: ' seven women '.

Possessive Pronouns

Examples: N'i: ra a·N ar'ig'əd eg'ə l'em i:k ' he had no money to pay me '; N'i:l' m'e: gə də wulu: ' I am not praising you '; gən ə bulu: l'e:nə ʃri:n' he:n' ' not to strike her with her own bridle '; N'i:ko:r' ə N'ih' ' it is not right to eat them ' i.e. hares.

The Prepositions do, de

Examples: ʃin′ e:n rud ə'ta: Nə sagərt′ ə je:nu: l′iN′ ' that is what the priests are doing for us '; əN tam ʃo gə vl′iən′ ' this time of year '; ə hug k′art gə Nə di:n′i: ' who gave the people (their) rights '.

Prepositional Pronouns

Examples: b′e:g′ən ɣum 'I had to '; riN′ə ʃe: N′art de 'He made plenty of it '; ho:g′ m′e: mə hu:l′ ɣe ' I took my eye off him '; xil′ə ho:rt rumpu: ' everything before them '.

Verbs

Examples: v′er ʃi·d er′ çip′i:n′ ' they grasped a stick '; abri:n′ ʃi·d gə m′in′ik′ e: ' they say it often '; f′ek′im′ ' I see '; f′ar ə d′ek′iN′ gə maih′ ' a man I would see to be good '; han′ik′ m′iʃə ʃin′ ' I saw that '; N′i:r han′ik′ m′e: ə L′ehe·d′ ə'r′iəw ' I never saw the like '; ə wakə tu: rud ə b′ih′ ə r′iəw ' did you ever see anything ?'; v′i:f (before pause) *bhíodh*, but he also said v′i:u: twice in similar situation; N′i: v′ej (before pause) *ní bheidh*; tig′ə m′eh *cad chuige a' mbeith?* ' why should it be ?'; v′ef was also used more than once for cond. *bheith*; v′eṭ ʃi·d ə ra:t′ ' they would be saying '; N′i: rəu/ro *ní ra(i)bh*; as final word in an utterance roh occurs, e.g. Nax roh?; fuə ʃe: ə'NuN ' he went over '; han′ik′ ʃe: Nuəs er′ aʃ ' he came back down '.

New formations in *-igh* are *caoinigh* from *caoin* and *íosaigh* from the fut. stem *ios-*, e.g. N′i: xi:n′i:n′ ʃi: mint′ir′ ' she does not cry a *muintir*-family '; xi:n′o:ḍ ʃi·d ən'ʃin′ eg′ ə Nuəj i: ' they would cry her there at the graveside '; ʃin′ e:N təuwər Nax N′i:si:n kud gə Nə t′i:rhi: muk ' that is why some countries do not eat pig '.

The relative pres. in *-ans* occurs *passim*, e.g. ʃin′ i: ən′ t′e:n ə hugəns ə'max ən xuəx o:g ' that is the bird that hatches out the young cuckoo '; Nuər′ ə xah′ənsdə L′ehe·d′ ə'n′iʃ ba:s a:lt′ ' when the like of you for instance must die '; Nuər′ e:r′i:ns ə La: ' when day dawns '.

One example of rel. pret. is: o:, b′an i: ə debr′i: gə kruəj ' oh, she is a woman that worked hard! '.

The fut. 1 p. sg. ending -əd occurs once in a quotation, thus: t′ukəd, erʃə m′iʃ *tiocfad, arsa mise.*

A peculiar mixed form occurs several times in the expression Na: do:k′ə tu: so:nrə gə . . . ' if you observe (take notice of) . . . ', e.g. Na: do:k′ə tu: so:nrə gə Nə f′ir ʃo ta: ə g′im′əxd p′el′ə ' if you observe those men that play football '. This struck me as being very like E. Mod. Ir. *dá* with pres. subj. as in *Desiderius*, line 6817: *dá n-ana tú annso* ' if you

remain here '. Outside of this one expression, however, JD did not, I believe, use this form of verb following Na: *dá*.

Examples showing forms of the copula are: Nax b'e: ə xi: wil' mid' b'erhi: er' aʃ ə'ʃd'ax ə hi:r' el'ə ' isn't it that we are going to be reborn into another world ?'; Nax b'ah ' n'est-ce pas? '; Nax b'in' raṭ ' isn't that a rat ?'; b'in' e:N uər' ə hoʃə ʃi: ' that was when it started in earnest '.

In the past *nach mba* seems to be common, e.g. Nax mə he:xdəx ə f'ar e: ' wasn't he a wonderful man ?'.

Word-List

acht beag/ná beag, ax b'eg ən f'ar ʃin' ' but for that man '; Na: b'eg ʃivʃə er ʃeʃən N'i: v'eN' b'o: ' only for ye, said he, I wouldn't be alive '; Na: b'eg Nə sagərt' N'i: v'ef dəun ə b'ih' aN ' but for the priests there would be no world '.

aghaidh, əij in phr. *ar aghaidh*, but i: in *le haghaidh*, e.g. ogəs bə woxd ə Na:t' ə v'i: ən'ʃin' l'e: hi: e:r'əNəx ' and that was a poor place for an Irishman '.

amharc, ə taŋk ' the sight '.

amhrán, wih'ə mid' əN to:ra:n a: ra:t' ' we heard the song being sung '.

athrughadh, han'ik' ahru: er' xil'ə ho:rt . . . han'ik' ' there has come a change over everything . . . there has '.

bac, əgəs Na: bak l'o:f ə kant' ' and don't mind them talking '.

balbh, e:r'i:n' ʃi: balәv/baluw ' she becomes hoarse '.

bathas, də wahəs ' your forehead, brow '; ən ɣruəg ə fa:s ʃi:s ən'ʃin' er də wahəʃ ' the hair growing down there on your forehead '; ə v'ek'əN tu: ən bahəʃ k'iN' ə ta: er' ' do you see the brow he has ?'.

beagán, ta: b'ega:n ə'gum gə fo:L' ' I have a little (money) yet '.

beathuighthe, f'ar b'ahi: ' a fat well-fed man '.

béicigh, ə b'e:k'i: oriN' ' shouting after us '.

bláth, k'e: hiəd Nə bla:ə əʃ d'eʃə g'im'əxd? wel' bla: Nə ho:g'ə əgəs ə bla: ba:n . . . ax kahi: bla: Nə ho:g'ə v'e umpərə mər əs ko:r' ' what are the most beautiful flowers in existence? well, the bloom of youth and the white blossom . . . but the bloom of youth must be borne as is proper '.

bogtha i bpota, boki: ə bot, rəuna:lt'i: ' rocked in a pot, rounded off ', i.e. ' smartened by experience of life '.

bóthar, bo:hər/bo:xər ' road '.

buachaill, ɣa: sgo:r boxəL'i: ' two score of boys '.

buailim ort, leigim leat, bul'im' ort, L'ig'im' l'at, said when picking team for a game.

cairt, kart′; l′e:m′əḍ ʃi·d ə′Nuəs gə Nə kartəxi: ‘ they used to jump down from the carts ’.

citil, k′it′il′ er′ ə t′in′i: ‘ a kettle on the fire ’.

claigeann, ta: rud ənə xlag′ən′ ʃin′ ‘ he has brains ’.

cliamhain, kl′iəwən′ ‘ son-in-law ’.

cloch thomba, klox humbə ‘ tomb-stone ’.

cnáimh, N′i:l′ kra:v′ falsə ənə kolin′ ‘ there isn’t a lazy bone in her body ’; kra:wə il′ə gə ′L′e:r′ i·d ‘ they are all bones ’.

cnapán, krupa:n f′o:lu: ‘ a lump of meat ’; han′ik′ m′e:n kripa:n, k′e:n rud ə v′i: aN ax kuəx o:g ‘ I saw the tuft (?), what was in it but a young cuckoo ’.

cogadh, v′i: m′e: aN ən′ vl′iən′ ə heʃi: n′ çe:d xogu: ‘ I was there the year the first war started ’.

coiglim, Nuər′ ə xagl′o:ḍ ʃi·d ə t′in′i: ‘ when they’d rake the fire ’.

coimhitheach, o: hi:r′əNə kihiəx ‘ from foreign lands ’.

coirce, sə ba:rk′ kork′ə ‘ in the field of oats ’.

corr-uair, ′koruər′ ‘ sometimes ’.

críochta, Nuər′ ə wil′ ə wo:n′ kr′i:xdi: ta: ʃe: L′iə sə golin′ (sic) ‘ when the turf is seasoned (dried out), it is grey in the body ’.

cruithneacht, v′i: mid′ ə tarənṭ krin′əxd ‘ we were drawing wheat ’.

cuach, əN No:tə əʃ d′eʃə g′im′əxd No:tə ə̃ xuəx, t′ig′ l′e:hi: ɣol suəs ‘ the nicest note at all, the cuckoo’s note, she can go up ’.

dá > **ná** *passim*, sometimes *á*, ‘ if ’.

dearc, əgəʃ jark ʃe: ə′Nuəs orəm ‘ and he looked down at me ’; wel′ d′ark, er ʃeʃən, wiL tu: br′isd′i: ‘ well, look, said he, are you broke ?’.

dóigheamhail, f′ar br′æ: do:ju:l′ ‘ a fine decent man ’.

dosán, wul′ m′e: ə Nəi dusa:n fri:x e: ‘ I struck it against a clump (bush) of heather ’.

draoidheacht, fi: ɣri:xdə . . . Nə g′urəxi: ‘ bewitched . . . hares ’.

dubh i dtalamh, eg′ Nə di:n′i: ta: duw ə daluw; b′e:N tam uN Nuər′ v′e:s mid′ə duw ə daluw ‘ the time will come when we’ll be rotten in the grave ’.

dubhán, N′i:l′ e:N du:a:n sə gat ‘ a cat has no kidney ’.

fad, ʃi:s er′ æd ə wo:hir′ ‘ down along the road ’.

faire, -adh, v′i: mid′ ə far′ orhu: ‘ we are watching them ’; v′i: ʃe: far′u: orəm ‘ he was watching me ’.

féachta, v′i: m′e: f′e:xdi: l′eʃ ‘ I had experienced it (seen it, gone through it) ’; Nuər′ ə ɣofəs əN din′ə fr′i:d′ ə dəun, ta: ʃe: f′e:xdi: er′ v′aləx ogəs er′ wo:hər ogəs er′ wo:r′hi:n′ ‘ when a man goes through the world, he is tested over way and road and lane ’.

folláin, fuLa:n′ ‘ healthy ’.

fríd, fr'i:d' ə dəun ' through the world '. The form of this word I found in Erris was hri:d', except in Doohoma where AOS had fr'i:d' as JD has here.

fuiseóg, fiʃo:g ' lark '.

gabháil, N'i: huku: l'o:f ə ɣo:l' ' they could not arrest him '.

gabháilte, v'i: ʃe: go:lt'i: ʃd'ih' ə br'i:su:n ' he was held in custody in prison '.

gaghar, gəiər ' hound '.

Gaoidhilg, ge:l'ik' ' Irish language '. This form was in use also in Cuing. In Erris the form used is ge:lg'ə.

geirrfhiadh, g'iri: ' hare ', plur. g'urəxi: and g'iriəxi:.

glaodhach, ə gle:x er' wadu:, er' xu: ' calling a dog, a greyhound '.

gnóaigh, ɣro:ə ʃe:n' g'aL ' he won the bet '.

gráin, Nax re gra:n' eg'ə ʃin' orhu: ' didn't *he* hate them ?'.

gróigíní, Nuər' ə v'i:N' ə d'e:nu: Nə gro:g'i:n'i: ' when I used to be making the footins (of turf) '.

idir, usually ed'ir', once pronounced ad'ir', ' between '.

innseacht, -ean, N'i: hig' l'o:fə xi:h'ə Na: gə d'o: inʃəxd ɣu:N' k'e:N a:t' ə wil' Nə flaihiʃ ' they can never never tell us where heaven is '; ta: m'e: ə g'inʃən o: mə xri: ɣi:v' ' I am telling ye from my heart '.

iomdha, əs umi: f'ar maih' Nax rəu po:sdi: ' it is many a good man that was not married '.

lán a' leabhair, der La:n ə L'əur' ' by the (full of the) Book !'.

lann, LaN Nə sb'el'ə ' the blade of the scythe '.

leac oidhre, L'ak 'əir'ə ' ice '.

léir, k'e:n rud əs l'e:r l'at ' what is it that is clear to you ?'.

lionn, galu:n L'aNə ' a gallon of ale '.

londubh, LuNduh ' blackbird '.

luighe, mə li: er' ə L'abi: ' lying on the bed '.

meisce, mə xir' er' m'iʃg' ' to set me drunk '.

millteach, v'i: dl'i:v sasəNi: ən'ʃo gə m'ilt'əx, Nax roh? ' English law here was terrible, wasn't it ?'.

muirnín, ə wurN'i:n' ba:n ' fair-haired darling !'.

ná < **nó,** ' for, because ', Na: ta:n' t'i:r' ə'ku: ' for they have the country '.

nádúir, bə wo: ə Na:du:r' ə v'i: sNə di:n'i: ' there was greater nature in the people '.

oigheann, ə xur ə Nəiən ' to put it in a stove '.

peile, ə g'im'əxd p'el'ə ' playing football '; ə g'im'əxd Nə p'el'ə 'fad o: hin' ' playing football long ago '. The word *imirt* is here confused with *imtheacht.*

ráit, sagərt a: ra:ṭ ʃin' ' a priest saying that '.

raithe, Nuər′ ə v′i:n′ g′iri: ə rah′ə b′i:n′ ʃe: ə far′u: ti:w hiər ɣe ‘ when a hare is running he is looking behind him ’; ə Na:t′ ə wil′ Nə kapəL′ ə rah′ə ‘ where the horses are running ’.

righniughadh, N′i: anhəḍ ʃi: ə Na:t′ ə m′e ə saləxər. N′i: hukə l′e:h′ə ri:n′u: aN. N′i: hukuh. ‘ She wouldn’t stay in a place where there was dirt. She couldn’t abide in it; she couldn’t.’

roc, plur. rik′ ‘ wrinkles ’.

ss, smadu: ə′max ‘ get out of the way, dog !’.

sacraiméid, əN da: hakrəm′e:d′ ‘ the two sacraments ’.

saoghal, sLa:nt′ə gəs se:l ə′gud ‘ health and long life to you !’.

sgaith, f′ar hu: ə wil′ sgah′ klag′əN ort ‘ you are a man with great brains ’.

smugairle, xa m′e: he:n′ smugərL′ an′ t′ir′im′ ə′max ‘ I spat out a very dry spittle ’.

soir, ʃer′ ə b′aləx ʃin′ ‘ eastwards in that direction ’.

sónra, wel′, ən rud əs m′asə r′iəw ə ho:g′ tu: so:nrə ɣe . . . b′an vr′æ: ‘ well, the worst thing you ever took notice of . . . a fine woman ’.

stúth, sdu:h ‘ stuff ’ (in shop).

suipeachán, Na: gə go:r′o:ḍ ʃi: sip′əxa:n ‘ till she’d prepare a shake-down ’; t′ig′ l′at sip′əxa:n ə ɣli:x er L′abə ‘ you can call a bed a *suipeachán* ’.

tadaidh, N′i: huku: l′iN′ tadi: ə je:nu: l′o:f ‘ we could do nothing with them ’.

taidhbhsí, m′as tu: ə m′i:N tevʃi: uN ‘ do you think are there ghosts ?’.

thall, po:sdi: ən′ʃo ha:L ‘ married over here ’.

taobh thíos, ə v′i: ti:w hi:s fu:N′ ‘ that were down below us ’.

tapaidh, ə ʃu:l gə tapi: ‘ walking fast ’. Compar. N′i:s tapəxi:.

tionntóidh, huNto: ʃe:n kupa:n eg′ f′ar el′ə ‘ he moved the cup over to another man ’. Note in Erris the form of this word is *tionntuigh.*

tiosbeánadh, t′ig′ən′ ʃi·d l′e: ′t′isb′a:nu: ugəd. tugən′ ʃi·d ′t′isb′a:nu: l′e: hi: də wahəs ‘ they (ghosts) come with a revelation to you; they give a premonition for your good ’.

toiseach, ə dəʃəx ‘ sooner, first ’.

tórramh, v′i: to:ri: aN ‘ there was a wake in it ’.

trumpa, N′i: hig′ l′at trumpə wulu: ‘ you can’t beat a tramp ’.

trustuigh, əgəs trusdi: n′ f′ar ə wil′ Nə La:wə gəs Nə kosi: er′ ‘ and trust the man with big arms and legs ’; vn. trusdu:.

tuile, til′ə ‘ flood ’.

úd, u:d ‘ that, yon ’.

úth, Na: v′ek′a: Nə hu:Nə v′i: ə′ku: ‘ if you saw the udders they had !’.

Surnames

Mhac an Déisigh. JD gave me his name in Irish as ʃe:məs ə 'kid'e:ʃ Séamus Mhac an Déisigh, and the family he belongs to as klaN' ək ə 'd'e:ʃ(ə) Clann Mhic an Déisigh. Note the shift of stress. It is evident that only two unstressed syllables /⌣⌣/, not three, are permissible here. The first form above is an example of one of those rare cases in which the article is given stress. Another example is found in Erris in the case of the name Mac an Deagáin (anglicized Deane), thus pa:rək' a· 'kid'əga:n' Padraig Mhac an Deagáin. In the latter case also two unstressed syllables immediately precede kid'- (see *Éigse* vi, p. 114 n.). Clann an Désigh is listed by Mac Fir Bhisigh among the Irish learned families under the head ' Leagha Éreann ' (see *Celtica* i, p. 92, and note to line 151). According to Woulfe Mac an Déisigh is a Co. Sligo name. It is also found in different parts of Co. Mayo today.

Clann Mhig Amhalghaidh, klaN' ə 'gãwlə ' Cawleys '.

Clann Héil, klaN' 'he:l' ' Mac Hales '.

Clann Mhic an Ultaigh, klaN' ək ə 'NuLti: ' Mac Nultys '.

Clann Uí Ruadháin, klaN' i: 'ru:a:n ' Ruanes '.

Ó Ceallacháin, o: k'aLəxa:n' ' O'Callaghan '.

Place Names

Bac, pə'ra:ʃd'ə Nə 'mak ' the Parish of the Bacs ', between Foxford and Pontoon. Cf. O'Donovan, *Hy-Fiachrach*, p. 325: ' Clann Aindriu an Bhaic ', and ' the district of the two Bacs '.

Baile Átha Cliath, han'ik' mid' ə ʃd'ax gə bal' a· 'kl'iə ' we came in to Dublin ', also ə mul' a· 'kl'iə ' in Dublin '.

Béal an Átha, b'e:l ə 'Na: ' Ballina '.

Béal Átha Ghairbh, b'e:l ah 'ɣar'iv', name of ford on the Moy at Foxford.

Caisleán an Bharraigh, kuʃL'a:n ə 'warə ' Castlebar '.

An Chuing, ə xiŋ' wo:r and ə xiŋ' v'eg, names of two rural villages at Pontoon.

Gailleamh, gaL'u:; ə guNde: Nə gaL'iv'ə ' in Co. Galway '.

Indeacha Thoir, na h-, Nə hiN'əxi: 'her' ' East Indies '.

Leath-árdán, L'a'ha:rda:n ' Lahardane '.

An Mhuaidh, ə wuəj ' the river Moy '.

Muigh Eó, kuNde: wi: 'o: ' Co. Mayo '.

An Pontún, er' ə 'buNtu:n ' at Pontoon '.

An tSráid, ta: ʃe: kurhi: er' ə tra:d' ' he is buried in Straide '.

Turloch, torLəx; mint'ir' horLəx ' the people of Turlough '.

Star Names

An Bhuaile Bhodach, ə wuəl'ə wodəx ' the Pleiades ' (?).
An Chéacht, ə çe:xd ' the Plough '.
Réalt an Eólais, re:lt ə 'N'o:ləʃ ' the Polar Star '.
Na Trí Réalt, ' the Belt of Orion ' (?).

Proverbs

1. əs fiʃg'ə kəur d'e: Na: N dorəs ' God's help is nearer than the door '.
2. Na: (for *más*) kam d'i:r'əx ə bo:hər (*adeir siad*) ax hart ə bo:hər mo:r ə Nak'ərə. Na: d'i:n ak'ərə xi:h'ə æd ə d'ig' l'at ɣol hart ə bo:hər. ' Whether the road be crooked or straight (they say) round the high road is the short cut. Never take a short cut while you can go round the road '.
3. Na: L'ig' də xri: ax l'e: də xarəd' ' Never give your confidences but to your friend '.
4. Na: tu:r sbir' gən xapəl m'i:n' ' Do not spur the willing horse '.
5. t'ig'ən' d'iə gəN anəxin' əgəs tugən' ʃe: baN'ə k'i:x gəN anro: ' God has understanding for your distress and gives breast milk to hardship '.

Fragments of Folklore

Bean Sídhe

b'an xi:nt' i:. N'i: xi:n'i:n' ʃi: xil'ə wunu: di:n'i:. ta: klaN əgəs mint'ir' aN. ki:n'i:n' ʃi: klaN ax N'i: xi:n'i:n' ʃi: mint'ir'. ' She is a *keening* woman. She does not cry every family of people. There are families having *clann* prefixed, others having *muintir*. She cries a *clann*- but not a *muintir*-family '.

Caorthanach

m'as tu: ə rəu Nə ki:rhənəxi: ʃin' ənsə dəun 'fado: hin'? ki:rhənəx ə v'i: aN Nuər' ə xur ʃe: ʃi:s gə Lox d'arəg i:. ' Do you think were those *caorthanachs* in the world long ago? It was a *caorthanach* that was in it when he (St. Patrick) put her down to Loughderg '.

Cagailt na Tineadh

kagləmid' ən' t'in'i: ʃo—dabri:ḍ ʃi·d fado: hin'—ə ku:dəx ə t'i: ogəs ə far'ə Nə di:n'ə gə La: ' We rake this fire—they used to say long ago—protecting the house and watching over the people till morning '.

An Ghlas Goibhneann

wuəl' er' ə xosə
əgəs bun əuNə bi:
əgəs huəs er' ə boLəx.

b'in' e: Na:t' ə meṭ ʃi: g'ih'ə—taluw maih'. N'i: i:si:ḍ ʃi: a·n f'e:r ax ə Na:t' ə rəu taluw maih', əgəs Na: wa:ka: ən barəL'ə fu:h'ə, L'i:nhəḍ ʃi: l'e: baN'ə i:; ogəs vl'i ki:rhənəx i: t'ir'im'; vl'i ʃi: hri: riL'a:n i:, əgəs N'i: hukə l'e:h' ən riL'a:n ə L'i:n, əgəs kaL'u: n wo: l'e: br'iʃu: kri:.

Buaile-ar-a-chosa (for some place name?)
and Bun Abhanna Buí
and above in Pollach.

'That was the place where she'd be grazing—good land. She used not to eat any grass except in a place where there was good land; and if you left the barrel under her, she'd fill it with milk; and a *caorthanach* milked her dry; she milked her through a sieve, and she couldn't fill the sieve, and the cow died of heart-break'.

Tobac Corp

ta: giv'ə mo:r l'e: hi: tə'bak korp, ogəʃ ʃəu e:n pad'ir': Na: mə L'e:xdi: gra:N'ə gan'i: er' ə tra:j, Na: rib'ə f'e:r'ə fa:s, Na: bri:n dr'u:xdə r' ə v'e:r . . . gə ga:r'i: m'i:l'ə b'aNəxdə d'e: ogəs Nə hagləʃə l'eʃ ə tanəm boxd ə ɣro:ə mid' əN tə'bak əs Nə pi:pi: er'.

'There is a great prayer for wake-house tobacco, and this is the prayer: not more numerous be grains of sand on the strand, or blades of grass that grow, or drops of dew on the grass . . . may a thousand blessings of God and the church . . . on the poor soul on whose account we have received the tobacco and the pipes'.

Tobar Beannuighthe

Tobar na bhFiann: ta: L'əis aN 'there is a cure in it'. If the *breac* comes out during the visit, then ta: də horəs l'at ə wal'ə *tá do thurus leat abhaile*, that is to say the sick person at home for whom you have made the visit will be cured from that moment. He knew it to happen, he said.

Alia

Na Deich nAitheanta

Na: tu:r' an'im' d'e: gən fa:;
kiN'i: ə si:r'ə mər əs ko:r';
tu:r' gəd ahir' əs də wa:hir' 'uno:r';
Na: d'e:n maruw, god', Na: dru:ʃ,
Na: f'i:n'iʃi: ə Ne:n xu:ʃ;
Na: saNti: b'an f'ar/din' el'ə Na: a:rN'e:ʃ.

'Do not take the name of God without reason; keep the Sabbath as is proper; give honour to thy father and mother; do not commit murder,

theft, or adultery, nor (bear false) witness in any cause; do not covet another man's wife or his property '.

Feóil a' Mhadaidh

v'i: madu: fado: ə gol ə'NUN trasNi: ə drehəd' əgəs v'i: kripa:n mart'o:l ənə v'e:l; ogəs NUər' ə han'ik' ʃe:n sga:, . . . əgəs xal' ʃe:n kripa:n ə v'i: nə v'e:l.

Na: b'i: ro'haNtəx ə xi:jə.

' There was a dog long ago crossing over the bridge, and there was a piece of beef in his mouth, and when he saw the reflection . . . and he lost the piece that was in his mouth '.

(Moral): Never be too greedy.

An Frog

wel', d'er ʃi·d l'umsə gə wiL' L'ah əN din'ə sə wrag. Na: do:k'ə tu: so:nrə gən wrag, ə L'ek'əN ti:w hi:s, er' ə win'e:l, ta: ʃe: mər L'ek'əN ə din'ə; ogəs ta: mil'e:r er', ta: su:l' er', mər Nə di:n'i:; ogəs t'ig' l'eʃ sNa:w mər Nə di:n'i:.

' Well, they tell me that there is half of the human in the frog. If you observe the frog, his cheek below, on his neck, it is like the cheek of the human; and he has a neck on him, an eye on him, like people; and he can swim like people'.

Tri Ni

tr'i: hop koxin',
tr'i: ba br'akə,
tr'i: bri:n baN'ə
ə hu:rhiN' gə xat.

' Three wisps of straw, three speckled cows, three drops of milk I'd give to a cat.'

ÉAMONN MHAC AN FHAILIGH.